E-tiGo — Open Questions Decision Report

Phase 1 & Phase 2 Backend — Decision Record for All Outstanding Questions

Prepared by: Engineering Team | **Date:** 16 October 2026 | **Document version:** 4.3 | **Status:** All Phase 1 decisions resolved and implemented; scheduled-ride booking window and fees decided by the client; balance due introduced; remaining scheduled-ride defaults and Phase 2 recommendations awaiting client confirmation

Executive Summary

This document records the decisions for all **26 Phase 1 open questions** identified during E-tiGo backend development, and the **Phase 2 questions** raised so far. Every Phase 1 question has been resolved and the corresponding code has been implemented and verified.

Phase 1 questions are grouped into five categories: Provider & Integration (5), Business Rules (8), Detection & Enforcement (2), EV Charging (2) and Wallet & Ledger (9). Two new wallet questions (OQ-34, OQ-35) cover collecting the new balance due. Phase 2 adds **Scheduled Rides** (7 questions; the booking window and fees were decided by the client on 16 October 2026, the rest await confirmation) and **5 other Phase 2 questions** (OQ-18 to OQ-22), which now have engineering recommendations awaiting client confirmation.

Items tagged NEW were added in version 4.0 (16 October 2026). Items tagged UPDATED changed since version 3.0 (13 October 2026); in version 4.1 (16 October 2026) the five open Phase 2 questions OQ-18 to OQ-22 received recommendations; in version 4.2 (16 October 2026) the client set the scheduled-ride booking limits (SR-1 and SR-7: 3 days ahead, 3 upcoming bookings); in version 4.3 (16 October 2026) the client decided the booking window (SR-1), no reservation fee (SR-3), the late-cancellation fee (SR-4) and a balance due for late cancellations and wallet shortfalls (SR-5, OQ-26), and OQ-34 and OQ-35 were added. All other decisions are unchanged.

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A. Provider & Integration Decisions

OQ-01 — SMS/OTP Gateway

Question

Which SMS/OTP gateway should E-tiGo use for phone number verification?

Decision

> **WhatsApp Business API** is the primary OTP delivery channel.
>
> - `WhatsAppGateway` — auto-selected in `AppServiceProvider` when the `WHATSAPP_PHONE_NUMBER_ID` and `WHATSAPP_ACCESS_TOKEN` env vars are set
> - `LogSmsGateway` — dev/testing fallback (logs the OTP to the Laravel log file)
> - WhatsApp was chosen over traditional SMS for cost efficiency and higher delivery rates in the Nigerian market

OQ-02 — Maps & Geocoding Provider

Question

Which maps/geocoding provider should E-tiGo use for distance, directions, and place search?

Decision

> **Mapbox** for directions, distance, and duration calculations. Multi-provider failover for place search.
>
> - `MapboxGateway` — primary directions provider; `HaversineMapsGateway` as offline fallback
> - `FailoverPlaceSearchGateway` — configurable provider chain: Mapbox → Geoapify → LocationIQ → Photon
> - Provider order configurable via the `PLACE_SEARCH_DRIVERS` env var
> - All providers auto-selected based on available API keys in `config/services.php`

OQ-03 — Card Payment Gateway

Question

Which card payment gateway should E-tiGo use for card tokenization and wallet operations?

Decision

> **Paystack** — Nigeria's leading payment processor.
>
> - `PaystackPaymentGateway` — card tokenization, charge authorization, and refunds
> - `PaystackWalletGateway` — wallet top-ups and transfers
> - `FakePaymentGateway` — dev/testing fallback (activated when `PAYSTACK_FAKE=true` or keys are absent in local/staging)
> - Config: `PAYSTACK_SECRET_KEY` / `PAYSTACK_PUBLIC_KEY` in `config/services.php`

OQ-04 — Emergency Services Dispatch

Question

Which emergency-services dispatch integration should E-tiGo use for its SOS/panic button feature?

Industry Benchmark

In Nigeria, dedicated emergency dispatch APIs (such as RapidSOS) are unavailable or prohibitively expensive. Bolt Nigeria, Uber Nigeria, and InDrive route panic events through internal safety teams. Nigeria's 112 emergency line is the standard public safety number.

Decision

> **No external dispatch API.** The SOS panic button will:
>
> - Send GPS and trip details via the WhatsApp Business API to an internal E-tiGo safety number
> - Auto-dial 112 (Nigeria's emergency line) via the `auto_dial_emergency` response field
> - Notify the Admin dashboard in real time via a WebSocket broadcast on the initial trigger
> - Store each incident with encrypted telemetry for the audit trail

Implementation: `SosIncidentTriggered` event (broadcasts to `admin.sos`), `SendSosWhatsAppAlertJob`, `auto_dial_emergency: "112"` in the API response, `WHATSAPP_SAFETY_NUMBER` config.

OQ-17 — Minimum App Version Enforcement

Question

What are the minimum supported iOS and Android versions, and how is version enforcement handled?

Decision

> **Minimum version set to the launch version** (1.0.0 for both iOS and Android).
>
> - `min_app_version_ios` / `min_app_version_android` stored in AppSettings — Admin-adjustable at runtime
> - Returned via the `GET /api/v1/config` public endpoint (no auth required)
> - `force_update` flag available for critical updates that block app usage entirely

Implementation: `ConfigController` — `GET /api/v1/config` returns min versions, `force_update`, `emergency_number`, support contacts and (since 16 October 2026) the scheduled-ride booking rules.

B. Business Rule Decisions

OQ-05 — Ride Cancellation Fee Policy UPDATED

Question

Should Phase 1 include a cancellation fee, and under what conditions?

Decision

> **No cancellation fee in Phase 1.** Riders may cancel freely at any point. The `ride.free_cancellation_window_seconds` config is retained for future use.

Phase 2 recommendation: introduce a ₦300–₦500 flat fee after a 60-second grace window, with an automatic waiver if the driver's GPS shows no movement toward the pickup within 2 minutes. See the Cancellation Fee Proposal.

Update (16 October 2026): for **scheduled rides** a driver has reserved, the client decided on a late-cancellation fee (the economy base fare, within 30 minutes of the ride time) — see **SR-4**. On-demand rides still have no cancellation fee.

OQ-06 — Driver Payout Frequency

Question

How often should driver earnings be paid out — on-demand only, or with an automated schedule?

Decision

> **Both on-demand and weekly auto-payout.**
>
> - On-demand: the driver requests a payout in the app, Admin approves, processed via the Paystack Transfer API
> - Weekly auto-payout (opt-in): every Monday at 06:00 WAT, auto-approved
> - Admin-configurable payout thresholds via `AdminWalletSettingsController`

Implementation: `payout_preference` column on drivers, `PayoutPreference` enum, `PUT /driver/payouts/preference` endpoint, `ProcessWeeklyAutoPayoutJob` scheduled Monday 06:00 WAT.

OQ-07 — Admin Role Structure

Question

Should E-tiGo use a single Admin role or role-based tiers?

Decision

> **Role-based tiers** implemented with five distinct roles:
>
> - `super_admin` — full system access
> - `operations` — ride management, driver oversight (and scheduled-ride settings)
> - `safety_operator` — SOS incidents, flagged trips
> - `support` — disputes, passenger issues
> - `finance` — payouts, reconciliation
>
> Enforced via the `EnsureAdminRole` middleware with route-level role requirements.

OQ-08 — Admin Refund Authority

Question

Can Admin issue refunds and fare adjustments when resolving disputes?

Decision

> **Yes.** `AdminRefundController@refundToWallet` — `POST /admin/rides/{ride}/refund`
>
> - Full or partial refund to the passenger wallet via `WalletRefundService`
> - Linked to the dispute if one exists
> - Claws back driver earnings via `WalletRefundService@clawbackDriverEarnings()`

OQ-09 — Gamification Tier Naming

Question

Which tier naming convention: Option A (Bronze → Diamond) or Option B (Seed → Forest)?

Decision

> **Option A** — industry-standard naming:
>
> - Bronze (0 pts) → Silver (500) → Gold (2,000) → Platinum (5,000) → Diamond (15,000)
> - Implemented in the `TierLevel` enum and seeded via `TierConfigSeeder`

OQ-10 — Carbon Emissions Baseline

Question

What baseline and per-vehicle emissions data should the carbon scoring engine use?

Decision

> **EU/IPCC averages adjusted for ride-sharing occupancy**, configured in `config/gamification.php`:
> - Baseline: 120 g CO_2/km (average private car)
> - Economy: 65 g/km · Comfort: 80 g/km · Premium: 95 g/km · EV: 0 g/km · Default: 75 g/km

OQ-11 — Surge Pricing Scope

Question

Is surge/dynamic pricing included in Phase 1?

Decision

> **Yes — fully built.**
> - `SurgePricingService` evaluates active rules by priority: manual → time_based → demand_based
> - `SurgeRule` model with `AdminSurgeRuleController` CRUD + toggle
> - Integrated into `FareEstimationService`; multiplier range 1.00–5.00
> - Scheduled rides (Phase 2) are quoted with the surge in effect at their pickup time; demand-based surge never applies to a future pickup

OQ-12 — Promo Code Application

Question

Should promos be auto-applied or code-entry only in Phase 1?

Decision

> **Code-entry only in Phase 1.**
> - `PromoController@validate` — validates user-entered codes against eligibility rules
> - `PromoController@available` — lists promos eligible for the authenticated user
> - Auto-apply deferred to Phase 2

C. Detection & Enforcement Thresholds

OQ-13 — GPS Collocation & Jitter Tolerance

Question

What GPS collocation threshold and jitter tolerance should the anti-offline-trip detection engine use?

Decision

> All thresholds configurable via `config/offline_detection.php` and env vars:
> - Collocation threshold: 200 m
> - Route match minimum: 60%
> - Minimum GPS data points: 3
> - Pickup proximity: 300 m
> - GPS sample interval: 30 seconds
> - Monitoring window: 15 minutes

OQ-14 — False-Positive Rate & L3 Overturn Authority

Question

What is the false-positive rate target and who can overturn L3 permanent deactivation?

Decision

> **Super admin can overturn L3 deactivation.**
> - `AdminOfflineFlagController@review` with `outcome=overturned`
> - `SanctionService@reverseSanction()` reinstates the driver and sends a notification
> - 30-day lookback window for sanction tier determination

D. EV Charging Decisions

OQ-15 — EV Charging Station Data Source

Question

Where does EV station data come from — a third-party API, a public dataset, or proprietary entry?

Decision

> **E-tiGo's own proprietary charging network only.**
> - Admin manages stations via CRUD endpoints (including delete)
> - No external data feeds — only E-tiGo-owned or approved stations
> - External station owners may apply to join in Phase 2
>
> Station data fields: name, GPS location, stall count, connector types (CCS2/CHAdeMO/Type2/GBT/Tesla), power output (kW), pricing per kWh, operating hours, real-time availability.

Implementation: migration adds `connector_types`, `power_output_kw`, `pricing_per_kwh`, `operating_hours` to `ev_charging_stations`. `DELETE /admin/ev-stations/{station}` is blocked while reservations are active.

OQ-16 — EV Fee Waiver Scope

Question

Does the EV reservation fee waiver apply to drivers, passengers, or both?

Decision

> **Drivers only.**
>
> - `ReservationService` checks the requesting driver's tier via `TierGateService@isEvReservationFeeWaived()`
> - Drivers are the ones making EV reservations for their vehicles

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E. Wallet & Ledger Decisions

OQ-25 — Wallet Limits

Question

What are the minimum top-up, maximum balance, and daily top-up cap values?

Decision

> All amounts stored and validated in kobo. Configured in `config/wallet.php`; admin-adjustable via `AdminWalletSettingsController`:
>
> - Minimum top-up: ₦500 (50,000 kobo)
> - Maximum balance: ₦500,000 (50,000,000 kobo)
> - Daily top-up cap: ₦100,000 (10,000,000 kobo)

OQ-26 — Fallback Payment Method UPDATED

Question

What happens when the passenger's wallet balance is insufficient for the final fare?

Decision (version 3.0)

Partial settlement: capture whatever the wallet holds, record the shortfall, and mark the payment Failed for admin review.

Decision (updated 16 October 2026 — client)

> **The shortfall becomes a balance due the passenger owes.**
>
> - The wallet pays what it can, as before, and the payment stays Failed until the rest is paid
> - The rest is recorded as a balance due (`wallet_shortfall`) and the passenger is notified
> - When the passenger pays it, the payment becomes Captured and the driver receives the rest of the fare, less the usual commission
> - How it is collected: see OQ-34 and OQ-35

OQ-27 — Refund Policy

Question

Should refunds go to the passenger's wallet or back to the original payment method (card)?

Decision

> **Wallet-credit-only refunds for V1.**
>
> - All refunds issued as instant wallet credits via `WalletRefundService`
> - Card refund: admin-only escalation path — support admins resolving disputes via `AdminDisputeController::resolve()`
> - Card refund may expand in Phase 2 if required by CBN regulations

Rationale

Wallet credits are instant, cheaper to process (no Paystack refund fees), and reduce chargeback exposure. Industry standard for Bolt and InDrive in Africa.

OQ-28 — Driver Earnings Settlement Delay

Question

Should driver earnings be settled instantly, after 24 hours, or weekly?

Decision

> **All three options supported:**
>
> - Configurable via `config('wallet.settlement_delay')` — default: instant
> - Admin-adjustable at runtime via the Wallet Settings endpoint
> - `SettleDriverEarningsJob` runs hourly to move pending → available when the delay is 24 h or weekly

OQ-29 — Cash-Ride Commission Handling

Question

For cash rides, should the platform commission be debited from the driver's earnings ledger? Should negative balances be allowed?

Decision

> **Debit from `DriverEarningsAvailable`** (the driver already has the cash).
>
> - Negative balance allowed up to a configurable threshold: `max_negative_balance` = −₦5,000 (−500,000 kobo)
> - Warning logged when the threshold is exceeded
> - `hasExcessiveNegativeBalance()` blocks ride acceptance (and, since 16 October 2026, scheduled-ride reservations)

OQ-30 — Minimum Payout Amount

Question

What is the minimum amount a driver can withdraw?

Decision

> **₦1,000 (100,000 kobo)** — configured in `config/wallet.php` as `min_payout`; admin-adjustable via the wallet settings endpoint.

OQ-31 — Payout Schedule

Question

Should driver payouts be on-demand requests or a fixed schedule?

Decision

> **On-demand with Admin approval:**
> - Driver requests a payout via `PayoutController@store`
> - Admin approves via `AdminPayoutController@approve`
> - Transfer processed via the Paystack Transfer API

Note: OQ-06 extends this with an optional weekly auto-payout (Monday 06:00 WAT) for drivers who opt in.

OQ-32 — Tips in Wallet Flow UPDATED

Question

Should riders be able to tip drivers by debiting their wallet balance?

Decision (version 3.0, 13 October 2026)

No wallet-debit tips in V1: card tips via Paystack, cash tips handed to the driver, wallet tips deferred.

Decision (updated 15–16 October 2026)

> **Wallet tips are supported. Tips follow the trip's payment method.**
> - Wallet rides: the tip moves from the passenger's wallet balance to the driver in one ledger journal, with no commission
> - Card rides: charged via Paystack (`PaymentService@addTip()`)
> - Bank-transfer rides: can be tipped from the wallet or a card
> - Cash rides: handed directly to the driver; logged as `tip_amount` on the Payment record

Rationale

The accounting concern behind the original deferral is handled by posting each wallet tip as a single balanced ledger journal (passenger wallet → driver earnings). This change was made by engineering at the product owner's request and **has not yet been confirmed by the client**.

OQ-33 — Regulatory Compliance for Closed-Loop Wallet

Question

Does E-tiGo need a separate PSP or MMO license to hold customer funds in its closed-loop wallet?

Decision

> **E-tiGo operates under Paystack's CBN-licensed PSP infrastructure.**
> - `PaystackWalletGateway` — all customer funds held in Paystack's regulated trust accounts
> - E-tiGo functions as a sub-wallet under Paystack's license
> - Additional safeguards: ₦500,000 max balance, double-entry bookkeeping, full audit trail

Action required: execute a formal partnership agreement with Paystack confirming the sub-wallet arrangement before public launch.

OQ-34 — Collecting a Balance Due NEW

Question

The client decided that unpaid late-cancellation fees and wallet shortfalls are recorded as a balance due (SR-5, OQ-26). How is it collected?

Industry Benchmark

Uber and Bolt ask the rider to pay an outstanding balance before the next trip; Bolt can also add it to the next ride's fare. The Cancellation Fee Proposal recommended blocking new rides for cash users until the fee is settled.

Engineering Default (awaiting confirmation)

> **The passenger cannot book a new ride until the balance is paid.**
>
> - Booking returns a clear "outstanding balance of ₦X" message; the app shows a **Pay** screen
> - The passenger pays everything outstanding at once, from the wallet or the saved card
> - Bookings made before the balance arose are not cancelled
> - Finance can turn the block off (wallet setting `block_booking_with_balance_due`) and can waive a balance with a reason
> - Not built: adding the balance to the next ride's fare (would need the driver to collect it in cash on cash rides)

OQ-35 — Paying the Driver an Outstanding Balance NEW

Question

When a passenger owes a late-cancellation fee or part of a fare, is the driver paid now (the platform carries the risk) or only once the passenger pays?

Industry Benchmark

Uber pays drivers the full fare and collects from the rider itself.

Engineering Default (awaiting confirmation)

> **The driver is paid when the passenger pays.** The late-cancellation fee goes to the reserved driver in full; the rest of an unpaid fare goes to the driver less the usual commission. Paying drivers up front would mean E-tiGo absorbs what passengers never pay; it can be added later as a setting if the client prefers the Uber model.

F. Phase 2 — Scheduled Rides NEW

Scheduled rides were built on 16 October 2026 (Uber Reserve / Bolt / Lyft model): passengers book up to 3 days ahead at a price locked at booking, drivers can reserve a booking in advance, and the ride is dispatched 15 minutes before pickup. The client set the booking limits on 16 October 2026 (at most 3 days ahead, 3 upcoming bookings per passenger). Every other value below is an engineering default chosen to match industry practice and **awaiting client confirmation**. All can be changed by operations at any time without a release (`PUT /api/v1/admin/settings/scheduled-rides`). Full reasoning and sources: Scheduled Rides — Decisions Report.

SR-1 — Booking Window UPDATED

Question

How far ahead can a passenger book, and how soon before pickup?

Industry Benchmark

Uber Reserve: 30 minutes to 2 hours minimum, up to 30–90 days ahead depending on the market. Lyft: up to 7 days. Bolt: 3 days (London launch), 72 hours (South Africa), up to 90 days (New Zealand).

Decision

> **30 minutes to 3 days ahead, at most 3 upcoming bookings per passenger** — set by the client (Augustus Opara, 16 October 2026). This matches Bolt's London and South Africa launches (3 days / 72 hours) and keeps the price locked at booking close to current rates.
>
> Still an engineering default, awaiting confirmation: one passenger's bookings must be at least 30 minutes apart.

SR-2 — Dispatch Timing NEW

Question

When does matching start, and how long does it keep searching?

Engineering Default

> **Matching starts 15 minutes before pickup** and keeps searching until **10 minutes after** the pickup time (never less than the standard 5-minute search). Passenger reminder 60 minutes before pickup. Wallet hold and ride PIN are created at dispatch, not at booking.

SR-3 — Reservation Fee UPDATED

Question

Should passengers pay a fee for booking ahead?

Industry Benchmark

Uber Reserve charges a reservation fee (for example £3–£5 in the UK). We have not seen one for Lyft or Bolt scheduled rides.

Decision

> **No charge for reservations** — client decision (16 October 2026). The setting stays at ₦0; operations could add one later without a release.

SR-4 — Late-Cancellation Fee UPDATED

Question

Should a passenger who cancels a booking a driver has reserved, close to pickup, pay a fee — an exception to OQ-05?

Industry Benchmark

Uber Reserve and Bolt (UK): free cancellation until 1 hour before pickup, then a fee (Uber charges the trip's minimum fare, paid to the driver); no fee if no driver has confirmed. Lyft: free until 30 minutes before.

Decision

> **The economy base fare, within 30 minutes of the ride time** — client decision (16 October 2026).
>
> - Charged only for bookings a driver has reserved, when the passenger cancels within 30 minutes of the ride time
> - The amount is the current **economy base fare in the ride's city** (if the city has no economy pricing, the base fare the ride was quoted with)
> - Paid to the reserved driver **in full**; never charged for emergency, safety concern, vehicle mismatch or driver no-show, or when operations or the system cancel; shown to the passenger before they confirm
> - Wallet and card bookings are charged at once; what cannot be collected becomes a balance due (SR-5)

SR-5 — Late Cancellations Paid in Cash UPDATED

Question

How should the late-cancellation fee be handled for cash and bank-transfer bookings, which cannot be charged after the fact?

Decision

> **Record a balance due** — client decision (16 October 2026). The same applies when a wallet or card cannot pay the fee, and to wallet passengers whose final fare exceeds their balance (OQ-26). How the balance is collected and when the driver is paid: OQ-34 and OQ-35.

SR-6 — Drivers Who Often Release Reservations NEW

Question

Should drivers who regularly give up reservations lose the ability to reserve (Bolt does this)?

Engineering Default

> **No penalty for now.** Releases are recorded in the audit log, in line with the Cancellation Fee Proposal's "track, don't fine drivers" recommendation.

SR-7 — Driver Reservation Limits NEW

Question

How many bookings can one driver reserve, and how is the reserved pickup protected?

Engineering Default

> **5 upcoming reservations per driver, at least 60 minutes apart.** No on-demand offers in the 60 minutes before a reserved pickup. At dispatch the ride goes straight to the reserved driver if they are online and free; otherwise it is matched normally. Operations can assign, move or remove a driver before dispatch.

G. Phase 2 — Other Questions UPDATED

These five questions were listed in the PRD for Phase 2 and blocked their features. Engineering has now answered each one with an industry-standard default that operations can change later as a setting. **All five are recommendations awaiting client confirmation.** Please confirm or change them before the Phase 2 build starts (Week 9); if there is no answer by then, engineering builds to these defaults, which remain changeable settings. OQ-22 also needs the client's target dates: no new city goes live without one. Options, intervals and the full list of edge cases: Phase 2 Decisions — Quick Reference.

OQ-18 — Third-Party Bookings: PIN and Tracking UPDATED

Question

When a passenger books a ride for someone else, who receives the ride PIN and the live tracking: the booker, the rider, or both?

Industry Benchmark

Uber: the rider gets a text with the driver's details and a tracking link and does not need the app; the booker follows the trip in their own app. Bolt reports that 2–6% of its rides are booked for someone else.

Engineering Recommendation

Both receive the PIN and the tracking (operations can switch either to rider-only or booker-only).

- The rider gets a WhatsApp message (SMS fallback) with the booker's first name, the driver, car and plate, the PIN and a tracking link that works without the app
- The booker sees the same PIN and live map in the app
- If the rider's message cannot be delivered, the booker is always shown the PIN, so the ride can still start
- The booker pays by wallet or card only (cash off by default, because the payer is not in the car); up to 2 active third-party rides per booker; 10 different rider numbers per booker per day
- The setting is saved on each ride at booking, so a change never affects rides already booked

OQ-19 — Vehicle Charging & Maintenance Scope UPDATED

Question

Should vehicle charging and maintenance tracking be EV-specific, general, or both?

Engineering Recommendation

Both, chosen automatically from the vehicle's fuel type.

- Every vehicle: routine service (every 5,000 km or 3 months), tyres and brakes (6 months), and the expiry of insurance, roadworthiness and vehicle licence
- Electric and plug-in hybrid vehicles also get a yearly battery health check and charging status
- Records belong to the vehicle, not the driver, so they follow the car if it changes hands
- Overdue service only warns. Expired legal papers block going online after a 7-day grace period, never during a trip

OQ-20 — Driver Scheduling Model UPDATED

Question

Should driver scheduling be assigned shifts or availability planning?

Industry Benchmark

Uber and Bolt do not schedule drivers. DoorDash lets independent couriers book time slots voluntarily, and they can still work without one.

Engineering Recommendation

Availability planning for all drivers; assigned shifts only for E-tiGo fleet cars shared between drivers.

- Planning is voluntary: no penalty for skipping a plan, and drivers can always go online. Operations use plans to spot gaps
- Shift mode is switched on per fleet car. The driver can go online 15 minutes before their shift; new offers stop 15 minutes before it ends; a shift not started within 30 minutes is marked missed and operations are alerted (no automatic fine)
- Forcing shifts on independent drivers would make them look like employees, a legal risk

OQ-21 — Dispute Escalation Tiers and Ownership UPDATED

Question

What are the dispute escalation tiers, and who owns each?

Engineering Recommendation

Three tiers, with a fast track for safety.

- Tier 1, Support agent: all new disputes; refunds up to ₦5,000
- Tier 2, Support lead (a new admin role): escalations, appeals, missed deadlines, refunds up to ₦50,000
- Tier 3, Super admin: larger refunds, permanent deactivation, legal and press cases, final appeals
- Safety concerns go straight to the Safety team with a 1-hour first-response target
- Tier 1 cases not resolved in 72 hours escalate automatically. No admin approves their own refund. One appeal within 7 days, to a different reviewer one tier up

OQ-22 — Cities and Target Dates UPDATED

Question

Which cities are being activated, and on what target date?

Engineering Recommendation

Lagos → Abuja → Port Harcourt → Ibadan, each launched when it passes a readiness checklist. The dates are the client's decision.

- Checklist: map boundary with no overlaps, prices for every class, at least 30 approved drivers, support and safety cover, state permits, charging stations for EV classes
- Suggested: Abuja no earlier than 6 weeks after Lagos is stable; Port Harcourt the following quarter
- Replace the city on/off switch with three states (onboarding, live, paused) so drivers can be recruited before passengers can book
- Pausing a city lets trips in progress finish and, by default, still serves scheduled bookings
- No database changes are needed: all Nigerian cities share Lagos time and the naira

Decision Summary Matrix

#	Question	Decision	Status
OQ-01	SMS/OTP gateway	WhatsApp Business API	Implemented
OQ-02	Maps/geocoding	Mapbox + failover place search	Implemented
OQ-03	Payment gateway	Paystack (card + wallet)	Implemented
OQ-04	Emergency dispatch	WhatsApp + 112 + Admin alerts	Implemented
OQ-05	Cancellation fee	No fee in Phase 1 (scheduled-ride late fee built, off)	Aligned
OQ-06	Payout frequency	On-demand + weekly auto-payout	Implemented
OQ-07	Admin roles	Role-based tiers (5 roles)	Implemented
OQ-08	Admin refunds	Wallet refund + driver clawback	Implemented
OQ-09	Tier naming	Bronze → Diamond	Implemented
OQ-10	Emissions baseline	EU/IPCC averages	Implemented
OQ-11	Surge pricing	Fully built in Phase 1	Implemented
OQ-12	Promo application	Code-entry only	Implemented
OQ-13	GPS collocation	200 m threshold, 60% route match	Implemented
OQ-14	L3 overturn	Super admin can overturn	Implemented
OQ-15	EV station data	Proprietary network + full CRUD	Implemented
OQ-16	EV fee waiver	Drivers only	Implemented
OQ-17	Min app versions	1.0.0, server-side enforcement	Implemented
OQ-25	Wallet limits	₦500 min / ₦500k max / ₦100k daily	Implemented
OQ-26	Fallback payment	Wallet pays what it can; the rest is a balance due (client)	Implemented
OQ-27	Refund policy	Wallet credit default, card admin-only	Aligned
OQ-28	Settlement delay	Instant / 24 h / weekly — configurable	Implemented
OQ-29	Cash commission	Debit driver, negative to −₦5k	Implemented
OQ-30	Min payout	₦1,000	Implemented
OQ-31	Payout schedule	On-demand + admin approval	Implemented
OQ-32	Tips in wallet	Tips follow the payment method; wallet tips supported	Implemented — awaiting client confirmation
OQ-33	Wallet regulatory	Paystack sub-wallet / PSP license	Aligned
OQ-34	Collecting a balance due	No new booking until paid; pay from wallet or card	Implemented — awaiting client confirmation
OQ-35	Driver paid on a balance due	When the passenger pays	Implemented — awaiting client confirmation
SR-1	Scheduled booking window	30 min – **3 days** ahead, **3** upcoming bookings (client); 30 min apart	Decided by client (gap awaiting confirmation)
SR-2	Scheduled dispatch timing	15 min before; search until 10 min after	Built — awaiting client confirmation
SR-3	Reservation fee	No charge	Decided by client

#	Question	Decision	Status
SR-4	Late-cancellation fee	Economy base fare, within 30 min of the ride	Decided by client — implemented
SR-5	Late cancel, cash bookings	Balance due (also wallet shortfalls)	Decided by client — implemented
SR-6	Driver release penalties	None; tracked	Client decision needed
SR-7	Driver reservation limits	5 per driver, 60 min apart, 60-min protection	Built — awaiting client confirmation
OQ-18	Third-party PIN/ tracking	Both rider and booker; wallet/card only	Recommended — awaiting client confirmation
OQ-19	Vehicle maintenance scope	Both: general for all, EV items by fuel type	Recommended — awaiting client confirmation
OQ-20	Driver scheduling model	Voluntary availability; shifts for shared fleet cars	Recommended — awaiting client confirmation
OQ-21	Dispute escalation tiers	3 tiers + safety fast track; ₦5k / ₦50k refund limits	Recommended — awaiting client confirmation
OQ-22	Cities and target date	Abuja → Port Harcourt → Ibadan, gated by checklist	Client to set dates

Action Items & Next Steps

#	Priority	Action	Owner	Timeline
1	HIGH	Execute the formal sub-wallet partnership agreement with Paystack confirming regulatory coverage	Legal / BD	Before public launch
2	HIGH	Set up `WHATSAPP_SAFETY_NUMBER` and create the `sos_emergency_alert` WhatsApp template in Meta Business Manager	Ops / Eng	Before public launch
3	HIGH	Confirm the remaining scheduled-ride defaults (SR-2, SR-6, SR-7 and the 30-minute gap between bookings) and the balance-due collection rules (OQ-34, OQ-35). The booking window and fees were decided on 16 October 2026	Client / Product	Before scheduled rides are announced
4	HIGH	Confirm the OQ-18 to OQ-21 recommendations (or pick another option in the Phase 2 Decisions report) and give the target date for each new city (OQ-22)	Client / Product	Before Phase 2 build (Week 9); defaults are built if no answer
5	MED	Coordinate with the mobile teams: (a) 112 auto-dial via `auto_dial_emergency`, (b) force-update gate via `/api/v1/config`, (c) the new `scheduled` ride status and scheduled-ride screens (see FRONTEND_UPDATE_SCHEDULED_RIDES.md)	Mobile Team	Next sprint
6	MED	Confirm the wallet-tips change (OQ-32)	Client / Product	Next review
7	MED	Name the Support Lead(s) for dispute tier 2 and say which fleet cars are shared between drivers	Operations	Before Phase 2 build
8	MED	Confirm the state permits needed in Abuja (FCT) and Rivers State	Legal	Before each city launch
9	LOW	Design the Phase 2 "apply to charge" onboarding form for external EV station partners	Product	Phase 2 planning

#	Priority	Action	Owner	Timeline
10	LOW	Decide the on-demand cancellation fee for Phase 2 (OQ-05 recommendation: ₦300–₦500 flat after a 60-second grace window)	Product	Phase 2 planning